Derya Akbaba, PhD

gotdairyya@gmail.com | gotdairyya.github.io | Google Scholar

Academic Appointments

University of Copenhagen *Copenhagen, Denmark*
Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Human-Centred Computing *2026 - present*
Focus: Data Quality in Responsible AI for Energy Systems

KTH Royal Institute of Technology *Stockholm, Sweden*
Research Fellow, Department of Computing and Learning Systems *2025 - 2026*
Focus: Missing Data – Reimagining AI Systems to Challenge Structural Silences

Education

Linköping University *Norrköping, Sweden*
PhD, Visualization and Media Technology *2022 - 2025*

- Faculty of Science and Engineering
- Advisor: Miriah Meyer, Co-Advisor: Lauren Klein
- Wallenberg AI, Autonomous Systems, and Software Program (WASP) Program Graduate
- Thesis: Shifting Perspectives: Conducting Visualization Research with Entanglement Epistemology

University of Utah *Salt Lake City, UT*
MSc, Computing *2019 - 2022*
Focus: Data Visualization; Human-Centered Computing

Cornell University *Ithaca, NY*
BSc, Industrial & Labor Relations *2010 - 2013*
Minors: Economics; Cognitive Science

Publications

Awards & Honors

2026 Best Paper Honorable Mention
IEEE VIS for paper [C10] (top 5%)
2025 Best Paper Honorable Mention
IEEE VIS for paper [C6] (top 5%)
2024 Best Paper Award
IEEE VIS for paper [C5] (top 1%)

Conference and Journal Publications (Refereed)

[C10] K. Blomgren, **D. Akbaba**, R. Wyatt, M. Meyer. *"It Seems Like Such a Simple Thing": Challenges and Opportunities for Giving Credit in Science Museums*. IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS). To appear, 2027. Honorable Mention.
DOI:

[C9] **D. Akbaba**, D. Paz Moyano Dávila, M. Gezelius, Y. He, M. Meyer. *Designing Vibes in a Science Museum: from @Science to @☺*. In Proceedings of the 2026 Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '26). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 2125–2139.
DOI: 10.1145/3800645.3813762

[C8] J. Rogers, **D. Akbaba**, J.S. Brown, A. Lex, M. Meyer, *Reflections on Traceability for Visualization Research*, Computer Graphics Forum (Proceedings of EuroVis), 2026.
DOI: 10.1111/cgf.70445

[C7] **D. Akbaba**, C. Svensson, C. Torelli, M. Callmeryd, M. Meyer, *Thinking Inside the Box: Considerations for Putting Data Physicalization Workshops in a Box*, Computer Graphics Forum (Proceedings of EuroVis), 2026.
DOI: 10.1111/cgf.70453

[C6] H. Lin, M. Lisnic, **D. Akbaba**, M. Meyer, A. Lex. *Here's what you need to know about my data: Exploring Expert Knowledge's Role in Data Analysis*. IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS), 32(1):11186-1196, 2026. Honorable Mention.
DOI: 10.1109/TVCG.2025.3634821

[C5] **D. Akbaba**, L. Klein, M. Meyer. *Entanglements for Visualization: Changing Research Outcomes through Feminist Theory*, IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS), 31(1):1279-1289, 2025.
Best Paper Award.
DOI: 10.1109/TVCG.2024.3456171

[C4] T. Kauer, **D. Akbaba**, M. Dörk and B. Bach, *Discursive Patinas: Anchoring Discussions in Data Visualizations*, IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS), 31(1):1246-1256, 2025.
DOI: 10.1109/TVCG.2024.3456334

[C3] **D. Akbaba**, M. Meyer. *"Two Heads are Better than One": Pair-Interviews for Visualization*. Short Paper. IEEE Visualization and Visual Analytics (VIS), 206-210, 2023.
DOI: 10.1109/VIS54172.2023.00050

[C2] **D. Akbaba**, D. Lange, M. Correll, A. Lex, M. Meyer, *Troubling collaboration: Matters of care for visualization design study*, In Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, 1-15, 2025.
DOI: 10.1145/3544548.3581168

[C1] H. Lin, **D. Akbaba**, M. Meyer, and A. Lex, *Data Hunches: Incorporating Personal Knowledge into Visualizations*, IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS), 29(1):504–514, 2023.
DOI: 10.1109/TVCG.2022.3209451

Workshop Papers & Extended Abstracts (Lightly Refereed)

[P14] L. Klein, **D. Akbaba**, M. Meyer, M. Antoniak. *Attention, Alignment, and other Feminist Concerns*. MOSAICS Symposium, 2026.
Extended abstract.

[P14] **D. Akbaba**, J. Park, S. Hsueh, E. Mekler, A. Payberah, V. Tsaknaki, *A Feminist Salon: Finding and Making Our Carrier Bags for Feminist HCI*. In Adjunct Proceedings of the 14th Nordic Conference on Human-Computer Interaction (NordiCHI '26 Adjunct).
DOI: 10.1145/3821402.3830192

[P13] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah, *Interaction Criticism for Narrative Visualizations*, Critical Computing Conference, 2026.
Extended abstract.

[P12] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah, *Ecofeminist AI*, Data Justice Conference, 2026.
Extended abstract.

[P11] **D. Akbaba**, *Craft, Reflection + Complexity*, CHI Workshop, 2026.
DOI:10.17605/OSF.IO/E4R9M

[P10] **D. Akbaba**, *The Value of Visualization Literacy*, CHI Workshop, 2026.
DOI:10.17605/OSF.IO/4N7RH

[P9] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah, *Unpacking Technology Through Interdisciplinary Reflection*, WASP/WASP-HS/DDLS conference, 2026.
Extended abstract.

[P8] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah, *Ecofeminist AI*, Data Justice Lab, 2026.
Extended abstract.

[P7] B. Vincenzi, N. Campo Woytuk, A. Gómez Ortega, K. Sauvé, L. Forlano, **D. Akbaba**, E. Forero, S. Thulin, P. Sanches, K. Kuksenok. *Bring Your Own Biodata (BYOB): Feminist, Corporeal and Collective Approaches to Datafied Bodies*. Workshop. Companion Publication of the 2025 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference, 2025.
DOI: 0.1145/3715668.3734162

[P6] T. Villalobos Lujan, P. Sengupta, **D. Akbaba**, S. Alessio-Robles, A. L. Dogan, M. Meltis, F. Shokooh Valle, L. Oehlberg. *Interaction Design as a Form of Decolonial Care*. Workshop. Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Creativity and Cognition, 2025.
DOI: 10.1145/3698061.3728395

[P5] **D. Akbaba**. *words matter || mattering words*. A Toolbox of Feminist Wonder: Theories and methods that can make a difference, CSCW, 2023.
Extended abstract.

[P4] **D. Akbaba***, E. Kaklopoulou*. *A speculative feminist knowledge elicitation system*. AI for Humanity and Society, WASP-HS, 2023.
Extended abstract. **Denotes equal contribution.*

[P3] T. Kauer, **D. Akbaba**. *"I Was Here: Digital Traces as Design Material*. Information+ Conference, 2023.
Extended abstract.

[P2] **D. Akbaba**, L. Klein, M. Meyer. *Reflections on applying feminist theory to visualization research*. Extended Abstract. Information+ Conference, 2022.
Extended abstract.

[P1] **D. Akbaba**, J. Wilburn, M. T. Nance, M. Meyer. *Manifesto for Putting 'Chartjunk' in the Trash 2021!*. alt.vis, IEEE VIS, 2021.
DOI: 10.48550/arXiv.2109.10132

Reports, Editor Letters, & Science Communication

[O4] G. Panagiotidou, A. McNutt, **D. Akbaba**, N. Hengesbach, M. Meyer. *Critical Data Visualization–Part II*. Guest Editors' Introduction. IEEE Computer Graphics and Applications, 45(4):11–13, 2025.
DOI: 10.1109/MCG.2025.3585321

[O3] G. Panagiotidou, A. McNutt, **D. Akbaba**, N. Hengesbach, M. Meyer. *Critical Data Visualization–Part I*. Guest Editors' Introduction. IEEE Computer Graphics and Applications, 45(3):14–16, 2025.
DOI: 10.1109/MCG.2025.3579638

[O2] J. Drucker, M. El-Assady, U. Hinrichs, F. Windhager, **D. Akbaba**. *Visualization and the Humanities: Towards a Shared Research Agenda (Dagstuhl Seminar 23381)*. Report. Schloss Dagstuhl-Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, 2024.
DOI: 10.4230/DagRep.13.9.137

[O1] **D. Akbaba**. *Visualizing Uncertainty: What can graphics convey about the character of data?*. Science Communication. Natural History Magazine, 2020.
Personal copy available upon request.

Professional Service + Teaching

Reviewing

IEEE VIS	Full Papers ('26, '25, '24, '23, '22), alt.vis ('23, '22), VISAP ('26, '25)
ACM CHI	Full Papers ('27,'26, '25), alt.chi ('25)
ACM DIS	Full Papers ('25), Pictorials ('26)
FAccT	Full Papers ('26)
Eurovis	Education Papers ('26)
ACM C&C	Pictorials ('25)
IEEE TVCG	Journal ('26, '25, '23)
Frontiers	Journal ('24)
CoDesign	Journal ('26)

Service

2026 ACM DIS '27 Organizing Committee
VIS Arts Program (IEEE VIS affiliated event) Program Committee

vis4climate (IEEE VIS Workshop) Program Committee
2025 CG&A Critical Visualization (Special issue) Guest Editor
Input Visualization (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
VIS Arts Program (IEEE VIS affiliated event) Program Committee
Bring Your Own Biodata (ACM DIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
2024 VISions for the Future (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
EuroVis Student Volunteer
2023 alt.vis (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
Information+ Conference Organizing Committee
2022 alt.vis (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
Eyeo Festival Student Volunteer
2021 Fair pay (IEEE VIS panel) Organizer
2020 IEEE VIS Student Volunteer
College of Engineering Diversity Committee (U. of Utah) Grad Student Body Representative

Advising

F2026 Alice Haraldsson MSc in Interactive Media Technology, KTH Royal Institute of Technology
S2026 Omar Yair Ríos Trejo MSc in Machine Learning, KTH Royal Institute of Technology
S2024 Camilla Svensson MSc of Design, Linköping University
S2024 Claudia Torelli MSc of Design, Linköping University
S2021 Pranav Rajan BSc of Computer Science, University of Utah

University Teaching

S2026 AK2202: Gender and Technology Guest Instructor, KTH
F2025 FID3216: Data Feminism Guest Instructor, KTH
S2024 TDDE39: Physical Interaction Design and Prototyping Guest Instructor, Linköping University
F2024 FID3216: Data Feminism Guest Instructor, KTH
F2023 TNM101: Advanced Visualization Design Guest Instructor, Linköping University
S2023 TDDE39: Physical Interaction Design and Prototyping Guest Instructor, Linköping University
S2020 COMP1010: Programming for All Teaching Mentor, University of Utah

Non-University Teaching [1]

S2026 Making the Invisible Visible: Counterdata, Hidden Labor, and Community-Centric AI for Justice Workshop, IASEAI Conference, France
F2025 Mapping as a Social Science Method Workshop, Maastricht University, the Netherlands
F2024 Data Crafting for Team Leaders Workshop, Östergötlands Stadsmission, Sweden
S2024 Data Crafting for Young Children Workshop, Visualiseringscenter C, Sweden
S2024 Data Crafting for Empowerment & Expression Workshops, Östergötlands Stadsmission, Sweden
S2024 Feminist Data Visualization Seminar + Workshop, Graphic Hunters Beautiful Data Series, virtual
S2022 Introduction to Data Science Workshop, Women Tech Council, Utah

[1] An important aspect of my pedagogical praxis is to extend my teaching efforts outside of traditional university spaces. I achieve this through workshops and seminars with non-profit organizations and professional groups, reaching a diverse range of age groups and communities.

Selected Experience

Interdisciplinary Engagements

2025	**FemTech and Feminist Tech Focus Period,** 3-day workshop about technology design @ KTH	*Sweden*
2024	**NORDES Summer school,** Week focused on socio-ecologically just design after progress	*Sweden*
	Digital STS Hub, Science and technology studies group sharing & supporting research	*Sweden*
	Feminist Wonder Working Group, Interdisciplinary HCI scholars developing a toolbox of feminist methods/methodologies	*virtual*
2023	**Dagstuhl Seminar,** Week-long event on topic of: "Visualization and the Humanities: Towards a Shared Research Agenda"	*Germany*
2022	**STEM Ambassador, Spring Cohort,** Semester long program run by U of Utah, that trains and supports communicating science efforts to the public	*USA*
2020	**CRA-WP Grad Cohort for Women,** Conference that supports women in computing	*virtual*
	ComSciCon 2020 Flagship Workshop, Workshop for training and supporting science communication to public	*virtual*
	Critical Code Studies, Working group to discuss code from critical theoretical perspectives	*virtual*
2019	**School for Poetic Computation,** Member of Code, Paper, Scissor Cohort examining material aspects of code	*USA*

Affiliations

2026, *ongoing*	**Feminist Pedagogies for Just and Accountable AI,** Research network across three European institutes for designing feminist AI education	*SE, UK*
2025, *ongoing*	**ColibrAI,** Research network across three European institutes for co-liberative development of AI	*SE, FI, DE*

Public Engagement

2026	**Data & Me (Datos & Yo) Exhibit,** Exhibit co-located with InterAcción	*Colombia*
2025	**Data & Me (Data & Jag) Exhibit,** Exhibit at local science museum [news] [news]	*Sweden*
	Data Crafting Workshops, Data physicalization workshops for children at science center	*Sweden*
2024	**Östergötland Stadsmission Workshops,** Data physicalization workshops for empowerment [news]	*Sweden*

Visiting Researcher

2021	**Polarization Lab, Duke University,** Conducted study with Dr. Chris Bail on computational sociology	*USA*
2020	**Marc Lab, University of Utah,** Conducted study with Drs. Bryan Jones and Crystal Sigulinsky on neurobiology	*USA*

Presentation + Talks

2026	**Thinking Inside the Box: Considerations for Putting Data Physicalization Workshops in a Box,** Eurovis	*UK*
	Exploring entangled threads in visualization research, SIGCHI Paris Chapter	*France*
2025	**Care, Craft, & Complexity,** Visualizing Knowledge Conference	*Finland*
	Exploring entangled threads in visualization research, Lecture Series at ITU Copenhagen	*Denmark*
	Exploring New Threads in Visualization Research, FFF at KTH	*Sweden*
	Responsible Computing: Sketching a different future for VIS research, VIG at Utrecht University	*Netherlands*
	Responsible Computing: Sketching a different future for VIS research, VIS Cluster at TU Eindhoven	*Netherlands*
	Are visualizations haunted?, Cest-la-viz Conference	*Netherlands*
	Changing Research Outcomes through Feminist Theory, Best Paper Session at IEEE VIS	*USA*

	Changing Research Outcomes through Feminist Theory, Atlanta Interdisciplinary Artificial Intelligence Network at Emory University	*USA*
	Responsible Computing: Sketching a different future for VIS research, University of Utah	*USA*
	Data Empowerment, Östergötlands Stadsmission	*Sweden*
	Feminist Data Visualization, Beautiful Data sessions by Graphic Hunters	*virtual*
2023	**Troubling Collaboration: Matters of Care in Visualization Design Study,** CHI Conference	*Germany*
	Troubling Collaboration: Matters of Care in Visualization Design Study, ITU Copenhagen	*Denmark*
	Staying with the Trouble: Applying Feminism to Visualization Research, King's College London	*UK*
	Staying with the Trouble: Applying Feminism to Visualization Research, City, University of London	*UK*
	Staying with the Trouble: Applying Feminism to Visualization Research, CIM at University of Warwick	*UK*
2021	**Manifesto for Putting "Chartjunk" in the Trash 2021!,** alt.vis Workshop at IEEE VIS	*virtual*
	Interactive Visualizations in Social Science Networks, Polarization Lab at Duke University	*USA*